Daily Content Intel

July 6, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here is something I do not think gets trained enough. Everybody drills acceleration, getting faster, hitting top speed, and that matters, that is real. But in an actual game, on a football field or a lacrosse field, an athlete decelerates more often than they accelerate. A 2026 paper in Sports says it plainly, decelerations happen more frequently than accelerations in competition, and they hit the body harder than accelerations do.

That is the part I care about. When you slam the brakes to cut, to plant, to change direction, your muscles are absorbing this huge braking load, and a

Sports Medicine review points at those high mechanical loads as a driver of tissue damage and neuromuscular fatigue. That is the exact moment a lot of non-contact knee and hamstring injuries show up.

So if the only thing you train is going forward, you are leaving the most dangerous part of the game completely untrained. The fix is to train the brakes on purpose. That same review says athletes need to skillfully dissipate braking loads and get frequent exposure to high-intensity decelerations so the body actually gets used to them.

Here is what that looks like on Monday. Controlled sprint-to-stop drills, where they build up speed and then decelerate under control. Landing and cutting mechanics. And eccentric strength work, so the muscle gets strong at absorbing force, which is what braking really is. Build the brakes, and you get an athlete who cuts harder and gets hurt less. Does that make sense?

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: In a real game your athlete slams on the brakes more often than they hit the gas, and that is exactly where they get hurt.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here is something I do not think gets trained enough. Everybody drills acceleration, getting faster, hitting top speed, and that matters, that is real. But in an actual game, on a football field or a lacrosse field, an athlete decelerates more often than they accelerate. A 2026 paper in Sports says it plainly, decelerations happen more frequently than accelerations in competition, and they hit the body harder than accelerations do.

That is the part I care about. When you slam the brakes to cut, to plant, to change direction, your muscles are absorbing this huge braking load, and a Sports Medicine review points at those high mechanical loads as a driver of tissue damage and neuromuscular fatigue. That is the exact moment a lot of non-contact knee and hamstring injuries show up.

So if the only thing you train is going forward, you are leaving the most dangerous part of the game completely untrained. The fix is to train the brakes on purpose. That same review says athletes need to skillfully dissipate braking loads and get frequent exposure to high-intensity decelerations so the body actually gets used to them.

Here is what that looks like on Monday. Controlled sprint-to-stop drills, where they build up speed and then decelerate under control. Landing and cutting mechanics. And eccentric strength work, so the muscle gets strong at absorbing force, which is what braking really is. Build the brakes, and you get an athlete who cuts harder and gets hurt less. Does that make sense?

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Coaches train acceleration. The brakes get skipped.
- 0:08 Athletes decelerate MORE than they accelerate (Sports, 2026)
- 0:22 Braking load = where non-contact knee + hamstring injuries hit
- 0:40 Train the brakes on purpose
- 0:50 Sprint-to-stop drills / landing + cutting / eccentric strength
- 1:05 Cut harder. Get hurt less.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

In a real game, athletes decelerate more often than they accelerate, and that braking moment is where a lot of non-contact knee and hamstring injuries show up.

If your program only trains going forward, you are skipping the most dangerous part of the sport.

Train the brakes on purpose: controlled sprint-to-stop drills, clean landing and cutting mechanics, and eccentric strength so the body can absorb force instead of just producing it.

Build the brakes and you get an athlete who cuts harder and gets hurt less.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book: threshold.clientsecure.me It's time to cross your threshold.

#football #lacrosse #speedtraining #changeofdirection #aclprevention #hamstring #athletedevelopment #strengthandconditioning #sportsrehab #returntosport #physicaltherapy #youthsports #decelerationtraining

Personalize this

- Which of your football or lacrosse athletes actually gets a deceleration block in their program right now, and what does it look like when you build it in, versus the ones you only train to accelerate?
- Tie this to a return-to-sport call you have made: when you clear an athlete off an ACL or a hamstring, how much of your criteria is about how well they can brake and change direction under fatigue, not just straight-line strength?

- Where does braking capacity live inside your CROSS framework, and how do you explain to a parent or coach that training the brakes is what keeps their kid on the field?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8761154/ | "Deceleration Training in Team Sports: Another Potential 'Vaccine' for Sports-Related Injury?"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8761154/ | "The high mechanical loading conditions observed when performing rapid horizontal decelerations can lead to tissue damage and neuromuscular fatigue, which may diminish co-ordinative proficiency."
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8761154/ | "Team sport athletes need to be able to skilfully dissipate braking loads, develop mechanically robust musculoskeletal structures, and ensure frequent high-intensity horizontal deceleration exposure to accustom individuals to the

potentially damaging nature of intense decelerations."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8761154/
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12846042/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take, put the massage gun down. I see athletes buzzing their legs for 10 minutes before a game thinking it is going to do something for their performance, and the research just does not back that up. There is a systematic review on massage guns, and here is what it actually found. For strength, for acceleration, for agility, for anything explosive, using a massage gun either did nothing or it slightly dropped performance.

In plain terms, right before you need to be explosive, buzzing your quad can actually leave you a little flatter for that first big effort. The one thing it is kind of good for is short-term range of motion and feeling loose, and even that only lasts about a day, and then it is gone.

So I am not telling you to throw it away. If it helps you feel less stiff, or it calms you down before bed, cool, use it for that. Just stop treating it like a performance tool, because it is not one.

Here is where your recovery actually comes from, and it is boring. Sleep. Enough food. Easy movement on your off days. Do those three things well and you will out-recover every gadget on the market. The gun is a nice-to-have. Sleep and food are the whole game.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your massage gun is not the recovery tool you think it is.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take, put the massage gun down. I see athletes buzzing their legs for 10 minutes before a game thinking it is going to do something for their performance, and the research just does not back that up. There is a systematic review on massage guns, and here is what it actually found. For strength, for acceleration, for agility, for anything explosive, using a massage gun either did nothing or it slightly dropped performance.

In plain terms, right before you need to be explosive, buzzing your quad can actually leave you a little flatter for that first big effort. The one thing it is kind of good for is short-term range of motion and feeling loose, and even that only lasts about a day, and then it is gone.

So I am not telling you to throw it away. If it helps you feel less stiff, or it calms you down before bed, cool, use it for that. Just stop treating it like a performance tool, because it is not one.

Here is where your recovery actually comes from, and it is boring. Sleep. Enough food. Easy movement on your off days. Do those three things well and you will out-recover every gadget on the market. The gun is a nice-to-have. Sleep and food are the whole game.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Put the massage gun down.
- 0:06 Systematic review: no boost to strength, speed, agility, or power
- 0:20 Pre-game buzzing can leave you FLATTER
- 0:32 Good for: short-term ROM (lasts ~1 day). That's it.
- 0:48 Real recovery = sleep + food + easy movement
- 1:00 The gun is a nice-to-have. Sleep and food are the game.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Put the massage gun down. Athletes buzz their legs before a game thinking it does something for performance, and a systematic review says otherwise.

For strength, acceleration, agility, and explosive work, a massage gun either did nothing or slightly dropped performance. The one real benefit is short-term range of motion, and that fades within about a day.

Use it if it helps you feel less stiff or wind down before bed. Just stop treating it like a performance tool.

Real recovery is boring and it works: sleep, enough food, and easy movement on off days. Do those three well and you will out-recover every gadget on the market.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT Book: threshold.clientsecure.me It's time to cross your threshold.

#massagegun #recovery #athleterecovery #sleep #sportsnutrition #football #lacrosse #strengthandconditioning #athletedevelopment #physicaltherapy #recoverytools #youthsports #performancetraining

Personalize this

- What recovery gadgets do your athletes and their parents keep asking you about (guns, boots, cold plunge), and how do you redirect that money and attention back to sleep and fueling?
- Give a specific example from your practice where an athlete's recovery

problem was really a sleep or under-fueling problem, not a soft-tissue problem a gun could fix.

- How does this fit your CROSS framework and Threshold positioning, where you are the person telling athletes the unglamorous truth instead of selling them the trendy device?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10532323/ | "The Effects of Massage Guns on Performance and Recovery: A Systematic Review"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10532323/ | "In strength, balance, acceleration, agility and explosive activities, it either did not have improvements or it even showed a decrease in performance."
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10532323/ | "Massage guns can help to improve short-term range of motion, flexibility and recovery-related outcomes, but their use in strength, balance, acceleration, agility and

explosive activities is not recommended."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10532323/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Low energy availability / RED-S in athletes (under-fueling tanks bone health and performance). Strong teaching lane, fresh, not yet cited (Frontiers 2026 Czech endurance-athlete profile + bone-health narrative review).
- ACL return-to-sport quad strength threshold (>=90% symmetry) and the 5.6% vs 38.2% reinjury split for passing vs failing criteria. Hold until after Aug 7 (ACL clearance cited May 9, inside 90 days).
- Adolescent nap timing for agility and perceived exertion (2026 soccer RCT). Pairs with the earlier sleep-extension piece once that ages out.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (2026-07-06): Mercola email was pure promo, filtered to nothing. Mike T. Nelson "Weekly Wrap Up" leaned on EAAs and the concurrent-training interference effect (Jang mouse study + 2026 Nutrients review) plus a Flex Diet protein podcast. Iron Radio ep 242 covered training and injury prevention after 50 (active-adult lean, not athlete-first). EAA/interference and concurrent training were both already cited in the registry in the last 8 days, so I steered away from them.

- PubMed / PMC (athlete-biased): concurrent training in team sports (2026 J Human Kinetics review), Nordic hamstring + sprint (MDPI 2024), adolescent sleep (multiple 2026), ACL return-to-sport quad strength thresholds. Nordic hamstring (cited Jun 18 + Jun 23), sleep (Jun 22), concurrent (Jul 3), ACL clearance (May 9, still inside 90 days) all rejected as too-recent topic families.
- Deceleration / braking literature: McBurnie/Harper/Jones/Dos'Santos Sports Medicine review + Gordon & Green 2026 (Sports). Fresh lane, not in registry. → Draft A.
- Recovery-gadget literature: Ferreira et al. 2023 systematic review on massage guns + Dupuy/Bieuzen umbrella review on recovery strategies. Fresh lane, not in

registry. → Draft B.

- Unreachable: MDPI article page (10249) returned HTTP 403 to the fetcher; used PMC-hosted sources instead where possible.